

HR-LP-2026-V1: COMPREHENSIVE COMPANY LEAVE POLICY (EXTENDED EDITION)

Document Control Number: HR-LP-2026-V1

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

Last Reviewed: July 2026

Applicability: All Permanent, Full-Time Employees

Approving Authority: Vice President of Human Resources

1. OBJECTIVE, PURPOSE & PHILOSOPHY

The company recognizes that balancing professional obligations with personal lifestyle needs is critical to employee health, productivity, and workplace safety. This comprehensive document details regular time-off parameters, administrative protocols, and compliance obligations. It balances operational demands with employee well-being.

2. ELIGIBILITY MATRIX

- **Permanent Full-Time Employees:** Eligible for all leave types specified in this document upon successful completion of the onboarding process.
 - **Probationary Employees:** Entitled to pro-rated Casual Leave and Sick Leave only. Extended leaves (Maternity/Paternity) are evaluated based on statutory eligibility. Regular leaves may not be granted during the first 90 days of probation except under emergency circumstances approved by HR.
 - **Part-Time / Contractual Staff:** Leave benefits are governed strictly by individual employment agreements and local labor laws, not by this general policy.
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3. CORE LEAVE TYPES & REGULATORY COMPLIANCE

3.1 Casual Leave (CL)

- **Entitlement:** 12 days per calendar year.
- **Purpose:** For urgent personal duties, unexpected family events, social obligations, or religious observances.
- **Accrual Engine:** Credited on a monthly pro-rata basis at a rate of 1.0 day at the beginning of each calendar month.

- **Operational Caps:** To prevent disruption, no more than 3 continuous days of CL may be requested at once.
- **Combining Leaves:** CL cannot be combined with Sick Leave or Maternity Leave.

3.2 Sick Leave (SL)

- **Entitlement:** 10 days per calendar year.
- **Purpose:** For recovery from personal illness, injury, contagious conditions, or scheduled preventative medical operations.
- **Accrual Engine:** Credited in full (10 days) on January 1st of each calendar year. For mid-year hires, this allotment is pro-rated.
- **Medical Certification:** A digital copy of a medical certificate from an accredited health practitioner must be uploaded to the HR portal for any sick leave lasting longer than 3 continuous working days.

3.3 Paternity Leave (PL)

- **Entitlement:** 5 working days.
- **Purpose:** For male employees to care for their partner and newborn or newly adopted child.
- **Eligibility Rule:** Continuous employment of at least 180 days prior to the expected delivery date.
- **Timeframe for Use:** Must be consumed within 180 calendar days following the delivery date. Any unused balance after 180 days is permanently forfeited.
- **Usage Split:** Can be taken as a single block of 5 days or split into a maximum of two blocks (e.g., 2 days and 3 days).

3.4 Maternity Leave (ML)

- **Entitlement:** 180 continuous calendar days.
- **Purpose:** Paid recovery and bonding time for female employees for childbirth or legal adoption of an infant.
- **Pre-Delivery Allotment:** Employees may begin maternity leave up to 8 weeks before the confirmed, expected date of delivery.
- **Post-Delivery Allotment:** The remaining balance of the 180 days must be taken immediately after childbirth.

- **Adoption/Surrogacy Clause:** Female employees legally adopting a child under one year old are entitled to 84 continuous calendar days of paid adoption leave.
 - **Extension Protocol:** If medical complications arise, an extension can be requested. This requires a formal request submitted to HR along with supporting documents from a medical board. Extended periods are treated as unpaid leave unless the employee uses their remaining Sick Leave balance.
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4. SPECIALIZED & ADDITIONAL LEAVE TYPES

4.1 Sabbatical Leave

- **Eligibility:** Available only to permanent employees who have completed a minimum of 5 years of continuous, uninterrupted service with the company.
- **Duration:** Minimum of 1 month and a maximum of 6 months.
- **Nature:** Strictly unpaid leave. The company will pause salary payments, benefits, and equity vesting for the duration of the sabbatical.
- **Permissible Purposes:** Advanced research, higher education, extensive travel, or personal rejuvenation. Sabbaticals cannot be used to pursue alternative employment or freelance work.
- **Approval Window:** Applications must be submitted to the Department Head and HR at least 90 days in advance. Approval is discretionary and depends entirely on team business planning and leadership backup structures.

4.2 Compensatory Off (Comp-Off)

- **Definition:** Time off granted to an employee in lieu of working on an official company holiday or a designated weekend day.
- **Eligibility:** Applicable to operational, support, and technical staff below the executive management level.
- **Earning Criteria:** Work must be explicitly assigned and pre-approved by the manager in writing. A minimum of 5 hours of work on a rest day is required to qualify for a full-day Comp-Off.
- **Validity Period:** Earned Comp-Off must be utilized within 60 days of the date it was earned. Unused Comp-Off days lapse automatically after 60 days and cannot be converted to cash.

- **Application Rule:** Comp-Off utilization follows the standard 2-day advance notice rule via the ESS portal.

4.3 Bereavement Leave

- **Entitlement:** Up to 3 working days of paid leave per incident.
 - **Applicability:** Granted in the unfortunate event of the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling, or parent-in-law).
 - **Notification:** Employees should notify their manager immediately. Formal regularisation in the HR system must be done within 5 days of returning to work.
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5. WORK FROM HOME (WFH) & REMOTE WORK OVERLAP CLAUSE

5.1 Clear Separation of Remote Work and Leave

- **Not a Leave Substitute:** Work From Home (WFH) is an operational arrangement, not a form of leave. Employees who are unwell or unable to perform their duties due to personal obligations are strictly prohibited from marking themselves as "WFH" to preserve their leave balances.
 - **Illness and WFH:** If an employee is too sick to fulfill their regular daily responsibilities, they must apply for Sick Leave. Managers reserve the right to deny WFH requests and mandate a Sick Leave application if an employee's medical condition visibly compromises their work safety or productivity.
 - **Childcare and Emergency Interventions:** While WFH offers scheduling flexibility, it cannot be used as a primary substitute for dedicated childcare. For planned child monitoring or family events, appropriate Casual Leave or Paternity/Maternity Leave must be logged.
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6. ADMINISTRATIVE OPERATIONAL WORKFLOWS

6.1 The 2-Day Advance Notice Rule

- **Mandatory Advance Request:** All planned leaves (Casual Leave, planned medical treatments, and scheduled Paternity Leave) must be submitted via the Employee Self-Service (ESS) portal at least 2 working days prior to the start date.

- **Impact of Failure to Notify:** Submitting a request late without a valid emergency justification will result in an automatic rejection by the portal. Any subsequent absence will be marked as "Unapproved."

6.2 Emergency Notification System

- **First Contact Window:** For sudden illnesses or accidents, the employee must contact their direct reporting manager via phone, email, or company messaging app within 2 hours of their shift start time.
- **Proxy Notification:** If the employee is physically unable to communicate, an immediate family member or designated emergency contact must notify HR.
- **Retroactive Regularization:** The employee must log into the ESS portal and submit an emergency leave application within 24 hours of returning to duty.

6.3 Managerial Review Discretion

- **Business Continuity Check:** Managers assess leave requests based on team capacity, project deadlines, and client deliverables.
- **Right of Refusal/Rescheduling:** Except for statutory Maternity Leave and urgent medical emergencies, managers have the operational right to defer or deny a casual leave request if it conflicts with critical business delivery dates.

7. ACCOUNTING, ACCOUNTABILITY & LEAVE WRAP-UP

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Leave Type	Annual Allotment	Carry-Forward	Financial Cash-out	
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Casual Leave	12 Days	Not Allowed	Lapses Automatically
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Sick Leave	10 Days	Not Allowed	Lapses Automatically
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Paternity Leave	5 Working Days	Forfeited (6 mos)	No Cash Value	
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Maternity Leave	180 Calendar Days	Fixed Block	No Cash Value	
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Sabbatical Leave	1 to 6 Months	N/A (Unpaid)	No Cash Value	
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| Compensatory Off | Based on Extra Work | Expires in 60 Days | Lapses Automatically|

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7.1 Holiday Interventions

- **Sandwich Rule Defeated:** Public holidays and weekend rest days that fall between approved Casual or Sick Leave days are excluded from the leave calculation.
- **Calendar Day Inclusions:** For Maternity Leave, the entitlement is calculated in continuous calendar days. This means weekends and national public holidays falling within the maternity window are counted as leave days.

7.2 Unexcused Absence & Abandonment

- **Disciplinary Alert:** Any absence from work without a logged application or managerial sign-off is categorized as Unexcused Absence. This results in an immediate deduction of daily salary (loss of pay).
- **Job Abandonment Trigger:** Staying away from work for 5 consecutive working days without any notification or approval is considered job abandonment. The company will initiate termination procedures and send a formal notice to the employee's registered address.

7.3 Exit & Separation Treatment

- Upon termination or resignation, all unused Casual Leave, Sick Leave, and Comp-Off balances lapse immediately. The company does not pay out cash for these unused balances during the final settlement process.

8. POLICY VIOLATIONS & FRAUD PREVENTION

- **Audit Checks:** The HR department performs quarterly audits on leave patterns to check for potential misuse (e.g., matching sick leave with long weekends).
 - **Fraud Penalty:** Providing falsified medical certificates or misrepresenting personal situations to secure leaves constitutes severe misconduct. This behavior will trigger immediate disciplinary actions, up to and including termination of employment.
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Corporate HR Endorsement:
Director of Employee Relations
Global Compliance Office
